Self Help Initiative for Sustainable Development

P. O. BOX 1164, 1000 MONROVIA, 10 LIBERIA
Office Location: Block C, Lee Hill Community, Johnsonville Avenue, Monrovia, Liberia
Website: www.shifsd-liberia.org
Email: shifsdliberia@gmail.com
Mobile: +231-(0)770024082 / 886 874-950 / 770215306

Organizational Profile

Name of NGO: Self-Help Initiative for Sustainable Development-Liberia (SHIFSD - Liberia), Inc.
Contact details:
Email: shifsdliberia@gmail.com or jburgess@shifsd-liberia.org
Contact persons: Jeremiah T. Burgess, Cell #: +231-(0)770024082 / 886 874-950
Website: www.shifsd-liberia.org

Office Address: Block C**,** Lee Hill Community, Johnsonville Avenue, Monrovia

Date of Establishment

The **Self-Help Initiative for Sustainable Development (SHIFSD)** was formally registered with the Government of Liberia on **May 30, 2005** as a national nonprofit and non-governmental organization. The initiative was originally founded on **November 11, 2000** in the Central Region of Ghana by a group of Liberian refugees. Following repatriation in **August 2008**, SHIFSD relocated its headquarters to **Johnsonville, Monrovia, Liberia**, where it continues to operate at its own premises. The organization is duly accredited under registration number **MFDP/NGO/AC#531871651** with the Government of Liberia.

Impact at a Glance (2024–2026)

Between late 2024 and 2026, SHIFSD reached a **combined total of 2,526 beneficiaries** through its integrated programs in education, climate-smart agriculture, financial empowerment, and community development. This achievement reflects not only the breadth of SHIFSD's geographical coverage but also the depth of its commitment to transforming lives. Each intervention—whether literacy training, livelihood skills, or resilience building—contributed to equipping disadvantaged youth, women, and persons with disabilities with tools for sustainable change.

SHIFSD's growing impact demonstrates its capacity to deliver results at scale, foster community resilience, and remain a trusted partner in advancing inclusive development across Liberia.

Strategy & Structure

SHIFSD's work is guided by a clear vision and mission:

- **Vision**: To envisage a society free of illiteracy and poverty.
- **Mission**: To alleviate poverty by expanding access to alternative education and entrepreneurship opportunities across Liberia's underserved communities.

The organization's strategy is anchored in three thematic pillars—Education & Livelihood Skills, Climate Smart Agriculture, and Financial Sustainability—which together provide a holistic framework for empowering communities, fostering resilience, and promoting sustainable development.

Core Values

In pursuit of its vision and mission, SHIFSD is guided by values that shape its work and relationships. We uphold **integrity** by openly communicating challenges to communities and donors in a timely manner. We practice **justice** by treating staff, partners, and stakeholders with respect, fairness, and honesty. Our commitment to **transparency and accountability** ensures that program management remains open and answerable to participating communities, donors, and partners. We embrace **participation**, valuing consensus building and shared leadership in decision-making. Finally, we celebrate **diversity**, striving to accommodate and respect people of varied backgrounds, experiences, and affiliations. These values form the foundation of SHIFSD's operations and partnerships, ensuring trust, inclusivity, and impact across all interventions.

What We Do and How

SHIFSD advances community development by promoting alternative basic education**;** provision of public secondary schools teachers & school leaders' training in partnership with the Education Development Center/Mastercard Foundation's Leaders in Teaching (LIT) Program**,** Village Savings and Loan Associations (VSLAs)**,** entrepreneurship incubation**,** and other pathways to sustainable livelihoods. Our interventions are designed and implemented on an integrated basis, ensuring synergy across education, agriculture, and financial empowerment.

Our current thematic pillars are:

- **Education & Livelihood Skills** – equipping youth and women with employable skills and practical knowledge.
- **Climate Smart Agriculture (CSA)** – strengthening food security and resilience through farmer training and agribusiness initiatives.
- **Financial Sustainability** – empowering families and communities through VSLAs, financial literacy, and entrepreneurship support.

Geographical Reach

SHIFSD currently operates in **Montserrado, Bong, Nimba, and Lofa Counties**, with established programs ranging from teachers & school leaders training, adult literacy and TVET to livelihood skills and CSA. In the past, SHIFSD has also worked in Margibi,

Grand Cape Mount, and Bomi Counties, where SHIFSD conducted surveys in partnership with Welthungerhilfe (WHH).

This broad footprint demonstrates SHIFSD's capacity to implement projects across diverse regions of Liberia, leveraging community structures and partnerships to ensure sustainability and impact.

This broad footprint demonstrates SHIFSD's capacity to implement projects across diverse regions of Liberia, leveraging community structures and partnerships to ensure sustainability and impact.

Human Resources

SHIFSD's day-to-day operations are guided by a seven-member Board of Directors**,** representing diverse professional backgrounds and providing strategic oversight. The organization currently maintains a workforce of **17 core staff**, complemented by **36 Master Trainers** serving as consultants under the *Leaders in Teaching (LIT) Program*. In addition, SHIFSD engages a network of field monitors, literacy facilitators, and other support staff who ensure effective program delivery at the community level.

The **management team** is structured to ensure accountability and efficiency, comprising the Executive Director, Program Officer, Finance Officer, Communication Officer, and Monitoring & Evaluation Officer. This team, led by the Executive Director, provides operational leadership and ensures alignment of all activities with SHIFSD's mission and strategic priorities.

Financial Resources

SHIFSD's work is sustained through the support of reputable donors and partners. Current partners include the **Education Development Center (EDC) / Mastercard Foundation**, **All We Can**, and **Mission Alliance**. In addition to these partnerships, SHIFSD maintains strong institutional affiliations as a network member of the Liberia National NGO Network (LINNK), the Consortium of Adult Educators (CAE), and the New Africa Research Development Agency (NARDA). Regionally, SHIFSD is also a proud member of **Pamoja Education**, further strengthening its collaborative reach and credibility.

Technical Support

SHIFSD benefits from ongoing technical support provided by trusted partners, including **All We Can (UK)**, the **Education Development Center (EDC) / Mastercard Foundation**, and **Mission Alliance**, among others. These partnerships strengthen

SHIFSD's institutional capacity, enhance program quality, and ensure that interventions remain innovative, accountable, and impactful.

Target Beneficiaries

SHIFSD's programs primarily serve **disadvantaged young people between the ages of 18 and 35**, as well as **persons with disabilities**. By focusing on these groups, the organization seeks to empower marginalized populations with education, livelihood skills, and opportunities for inclusion, thereby fostering resilience and sustainable community development.

Partnerships

SHIFSD actively seeks and cultivates partnerships with **local and international organizations, academic institutions as well as public and private sector entities** that share its vision and mission. Through these collaborations, the organization leverages technical expertise, resources, and shared values to expand its reach, strengthen program delivery, and maximize impact across communities in Liberia.

Our current and past recent activities and interventions

- From 2025 – present, SHIFSD serves as one of the ten local and regional implementing partners working in partnership with the Education Development Center/Mastercard Foundation on its Leaders in teaching Program covering all fifteen counties of the country. SHIFSD is exclusively assigned to Bong County, and Montserrado County #1 as well as three districts in Nimba County covering a combined total of 65 public schools.

  The MasterCard Foundation's Leaders in Teaching (LIT) initiative aims to transform secondary education across Africa by strengthening teaching and learning at the secondary level. The program focuses on ensuring that young people acquire 21st-century skills and competencies necessary for employment, lifelong learning, and successful adult lives.

- From January 2025 – present, SHIFSD in partnership with Mission Alliance is implementing the Adult Education Project (AEP) in the Zorzor and Salayea Districts in Lofa County covering 30 communities empowering illiterate Liberians in underserved communities.

- From 2023 – present, with both financial and technical support from All We Can, SHIFSD is implementing its five year strategic plan (2024 -2028) with emphasis on financial sustainability.

  As part of social enterprise initiatives, SHIFSD is providing technical, vocational skills training and academic programs to young people through its Holy Hands

Institute, & Hummingbird Academy which are located at the SHIFSD's Multipurpose Youth Training Center in the township of Johnsonville, Monrovia.

Track Record Summary

Since its establishment, SHIFSD has demonstrated strong capacity to design, implement, and manage complex, donor-funded programs across Liberia. Between 2022 and 2024, SHIFSD reached over **1,395 youth in 12 communities** with literacy, numeracy, VSLA, and soft skills training under the *USAID Youth Advance Activity*. Through the *Elections and Democracy Activity (EDA)*, SHIFSD partnered with **Democracy International** and **WE4SELF** to strengthen women's leadership in four southeastern counties. In 2024, SHIFSD conducted a **baseline survey with 305 households in Nimba County** for the AWC/Y-Care International Project, assessing food security and resilience. In 2023, SHIFSD provided consultancy to **Welthungerhilfe (WHH)**, mapping **50 storage facilities** across three counties, mentoring local management committees, and conducting an **end-line survey with 300 respondents**.

This track record reflects SHIFSD's ability to deliver results in education, democracy, livelihoods, and resilience programming, while maintaining accountability and impact across multiple counties and diverse thematic areas.